CLASS 9 SST • CIVICS • CHAPTER 7

Elections

Premium Last-Minute Revision Booklet

Exam-focused short notes covering the full chapter — why elections matter, FPTP vs proportional representation, election laws (RPA 1950 & 1951), delimitation, the Election Commission's powers & digital initiatives, political parties and recognition criteria, the Anti-Defection Law, coalitions, and challenges to free & fair elections — with Hinglish explanations and a 5-minute rapid revision.

🗳️ 1 Civics Chapter | ⚖️ FPTP vs PR | ⚡ 5-Minute Revision | 💡 Hinglish Explanations | 🎯 Exam-Oriented

Source: Understanding Society: India and Beyond • Grade 9 – Part 1
Use: Quick revision before school tests & exams

SHORT NOTES • RAPID REVISION SERIES

1 Chapter at a Glance

- **One-line overview:** How India runs the world's largest democratic exercise — the electoral systems that convert votes into seats, the laws and institutions (ECI, Delimitation Commission) that keep elections free & fair, and the role of political parties.
- Big Questions: (1) Why are elections essential to democracy? (2) How do electoral systems shape representation & fairness? (3) What role do institutions & laws play in free & fair elections? (4) What challenges do elections face?
- **Election** = a process through which we **exercise the right to vote** and fulfil our responsibility as citizens. **Regular, periodic elections lie at the core of democracy.** 🔥 MUST REMEMBER
- Elections matter because they deliver: **Accountability, Representation, Legitimacy, Equality** — elected representatives are accountable to the people; our **vote is the principal means** of exercising this right.

> 💡 **HINGLISH ME SAMJHO — Elections ka importance**
>
> Elections = **democracy ki soul**. Isse 4 cheezein milti hain: **Accountability** (behave karo warna 5 saal baad nikal denge), **Representation** (tumhari awaaz ek representative), **Legitimacy** (janta ki mandate se hi sarkar banti hai), **Equality** (sabki vote barabar — PM ki bhi, kiraye-daar ki bhi). Bina elections ke, sarkar ko koi jawab-dehi nahi hoti.

2 Key Terms & Definitions

Term	Meaning (exam-ready)
Direct elections	Citizens **vote directly** to choose their representatives (Lok Sabha, Vidhan Sabha, local bodies)
Indirect elections	Citizens vote for representatives who then **choose/elect the leaders** (President, Vice President, Rajya Sabha)
Psephology	**Scientific study of elections** — from Greek *psēphos* = "pebble" (ancient Greeks voted with pebbles) 📌 EXAM POINT
Constituency	A territorial area whose voters elect one representative
Electoral system	Method of **converting votes cast into seats** in the legislature
FPTP	**First-Past-The-Post (plurality system)** — candidate with the MOST votes wins, even if less than 50%
Majority system	Two-round system — winner needs **>50%**; else top two compete in a second round
Proportional Representation (PR)	Seats allotted in **proportion to total votes** received by each party

Single Transferable Vote (STV)	PR method: voters mark **preferences**; votes of eliminated candidates are **transferred** until enough candidates reach the **quota**
Quota	Minimum votes needed to win = **total valid votes ÷ seats to be filled**
Vidhan Parishad	Legislative Council — the **Upper House** in bicameral states
Delimitation	Process of determining the number of seats & fixing territorial boundaries of constituencies — keeps the **seats-to-population ratio nearly equal**
Electoral roll	Voters' list for each constituency, organised **polling-station-wise**; only those on the roll can vote
SIR	**Special Intensive Revision** — updating, verifying & correcting electoral rolls (add eligible voters, delete dead/shifted/duplicate/untraceable)
Defection	**Abandoning/switching** from the party on whose ticket a member was elected — "political opportunism" (or conscience, depending on view)
Whip	Party's voting instruction in the legislature — voting against it can disqualify a member
RUPP	**Registered Unrecognised Political Parties** — parties without enough votes/seats, or never contested since registration
Coalition government	Government formed by an **alliance** of parties (first at national level: Janata Party, 1977)
VVPAT	Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail — printed slip lets voters **verify** their vote
ETPBS	Electronically Transmitted Postal Ballot System — lets **service voters** cast postal ballots electronically from outside their constituency
MCC	Model Code of Conduct — rules for campaigns; violations reportable via cVIGIL

3 The Electoral System — FPTP vs PR 🔥 MUST REMEMBER (whole section)

- First step of conducting elections = deciding how **votes convert into seats**. The framers of the Constitution chose the **plurality (FPTP)** system.
- **FPTP is used for: Lok Sabha + Vidhan Sabha** elections. **Proportional Representation is used for: Rajya Sabha, President, Vice President** (and Vidhan Parishad — via STV). 📌 EXAM POINT

Feature	First Past The Post (FPTP)	Majority System (2 rounds)	Proportional Representation (PR)
How voting works	Each voter votes for one candidate in their constituency; candidate with the **most votes wins even if <50%**	Candidate needs **>50%**; if not, the **top two compete in a second round**	Voters vote for a **party, not a person**; seats allotted in **proportion to total votes**

Textbook example	Haritbhumi: A 40%, B 35%, C 25% → **Party A forms the government** (with only 40%!) 📌 EXAM POINT	Ratnadeep: no one crossed 50% in Round 1 → Round 2: **Y wins with 55%**	Swarnalok (100 seats): M 40%, N 35%, O 15%, P 10% → seats **M:40, N:35, O:15, P:10** — power shared proportionately
Who forms govt	Party with most seats (may be <50% of votes)	Round-2 winner (majority)	Coalitions — shares power by vote share

3.1 Single Transferable Vote (STV) — counting & transfer 📌 EXAM POINT

STV — how it works	
QUOTA	Quota = **Total valid votes ÷ Seats to be filled** = minimum votes to win
STEP 1	Voters **mark preferences** (1st, 2nd, 3rd...)
STEP 2	**First-preference votes counted** for all candidates; those reaching the **quota are declared elected**
STEP 3	Candidate with the **lowest votes is eliminated**; their votes are **transferred** to the candidates marked as **second preference** on those ballot papers
STEP 4	Process continues until the **required number of candidates are elected**

- **Vidhan Parishad elections** also use **PR by means of STV**.

> 💡 **HINGLISH ME SAMJHO — FPTP vs PR**
> **FPTP** = "race ka winner" — jo candidate sabse zyada votes laaye, woh jeet gaya, chahe uski 30% hi kyun na ho (Haritbhumi: A ko 40% mila, B 35%, C 25% — A jeet gaya!). **Majority** = "50% + dikhaao" — nahi dikha to top-2 dobara race. **PR** = "proportion mein seats" — party ko jitne % votes, utni % seats (jaise Swarnalok mein 40% votes = 40 seats). Isliye FPTP mein winner ho sakte hain "minority-vote wala", PR mein power share hoti hai. STV = PR + preference transfer (eliminated candidate ke votes doosre ko jaate hain).

3.2 Bicameral States — 6 states have a Vidhan Parishad 📌 EXAM POINT

- **Six bicameral states: Andhra Pradesh, Bihar, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Telangana, Uttar Pradesh.**
- **Vidhan Sabha** = Lower House (directly elected; makes laws for the State/UTs; FPTP). **Vidhan Parishad** = Upper House.
- **Vidhan Parishad's members:** elected by **members of the Vidhan Sabha & local bodies**, and also by **graduates and teachers** of the state; **Governor nominates some members** for fields like art, science, social service, literature, co-operatives.

4 The Laws Governing Elections 🔥 MUST REMEMBER

Law	What it covers

Representation of the People Act, 1950	**"Rolls & boundaries"** — allocation of seats, **delimitation of constituencies**, preparation & revision of **electoral rolls**; ensures every citizen **18+** has the right to vote without discrimination
Representation of the People Act, 1951	**"Conduct & disputes"** — all other aspects of conducting elections: **nomination of candidates, campaigns, voting procedures, post-election disputes**; lists **electoral offences & corrupt practices**
Presidential & Vice-Presidential Act, 1952	Rules for Presidential & Vice-Presidential elections

*Trick: **1950 = foundation (rolls + delimitation); 1951 = fighting (conduct + disputes).***

4.1 Corrupt practices (RPA 1951) 📌 EXAM POINT

- **Bribery:** any gift, offer or promise by a candidate (or with their consent) to make a person **contest, withdraw, vote or refrain from voting**.
- **Communal appeal:** appealing to vote or refrain from voting on the basis of **religion, caste, race, community, or language**.
- **Misuse of government personnel:** candidates (or anyone on their behalf) cannot take assistance from government-related personnel — **gazetted officers, judges & magistrates, armed forces, police, excise officers**.

5 Delimitation Commission

- Constituency boundaries are **NOT permanently fixed** — they change with shifts in population density.
- **Why it matters:** without delimitation, one MP might represent 5 lakh people while another represents 25 lakh — defeating **equal representation**.
- **Delimitation** = determining the number of seats & fixing territorial boundaries in each state for **Lok Sabha & Vidhan Sabha** elections; aim: seats-to-population ratio as close to equal as possible.
- **Article 82** of the Constitution mandates the Delimitation Commission. **Four commissions so far: 1952, 1963, 1973, 2002** (long gap 1973→2002). 🔥 MUST REMEMBER

> 💡 **HINGLISH ME SAMJHO — Delimitation**
>
> Simple idea: **ek MLA/MP kitne logon ko represent kare?** Agar ek constituency mein 5 lakh log aur doosri mein 25 lakh — toh unfair hai! Delimitation = boundaries ko adjust karna taaki har constituency mein **barabar population** rahe. Jaise classes ko sections mein divide karna taaki har section mein barabar students hon. 1952, 1963, 1973, 2002 — 4 baar hua hai.

6 Election Commission of India (ECI) 🔥 MUST REMEMBER (whole section)

- Constitution vests in the ECI the **superintendence, direction, and control** of the entire process for the conduct of elections. 📌 EXAM POINT (phrase)

- ECI = **autonomous, permanent, constitutional body**; established **25 January 1950** — that's why **25 January = National Voters' Day**! Conducts elections to the **Lok Sabha, Rajya Sabha, Vidhan Sabha, Vidhan Parishad, President & Vice President**.
- **Articles 324–329** provide for the ECI's establishment, powers & duties. 📌 EXAM POINT
- **State level: Chief Electoral Officer (CEO)** — appointed by the ECI from civil servants in consultation with the state government; state officers (District Magistrates, Sub-Divisional Magistrates, Tahsildars) serve as **District Election Officers, Returning Officers, Electoral Registration Officers**.

6.1 Functions of the ECI

① Creates & maintains the electoral roll

How	Official **enumerators** visit every household to collect data on eligible electors → rolls prepared for each constituency, **organised polling-station-wise**; only those on the roll can vote
SIR	**Special Intensive Revision** = updating, verifying & correcting rolls — adds **young voters who just turned 18**, deletes names of voters who **died, shifted residence, are duplicate enrolments or permanently untraceable**
Fairness	Time given to raise **claims & objections**; settled before the final roll is published

② Decides the schedule and dates

When	When the constitutionally mandated 5-year term ends, OR the legislature is **dissolved before completion**
Factors	**Weather, agricultural cycle, school/university exams, festivals** (huge & diverse country!)

③ Registers political parties & allocates symbols

Registration	Only parties **registered with the ECI** can contest; **independent candidates** (not affiliated to any party) can also contest
Inner-party democracy	ECI insists parties hold **organisational elections periodically**
Classification	**National parties, state/regional parties, registered-unrecognised parties (RUPP)**; national & state parties get **election symbols**; ECI acts as a **quasi-judicial body** in disputes over party recognition & symbol allotment

④ Ensures free, fair & inclusive elections

Why	If fairness fails, public confidence weakens — elections may be "held" but their **democratic value is reduced**
Inclusion	Focus on **PwDs, senior citizens, transgender persons, PVTGs**; **voting from home** for senior citizens **above 85** & PwDs with **40% benchmark disability** — extended across India for the first time in the **2024 General Elections**; **EVMs with Braille**

6.2 ECI's Digital Ecosystem 📌 EXAM POINT (any 3–4 apps)

App / System	Purpose
Suvidha	App for **contesting candidates & parties** — nomination forms, permissions (meetings, rallies, vehicles, loudspeakers), real-time permission status
Voter Helpline App	Multipurpose voter services — **registration, transposition, verification**, election news & updates
ENCORE	Seamless **form processing & database handling** — efficient form-processing, simplified dashboards, role-based access, maintenance of e-rolls
Saksham App	Customised services for **PwDs** — registration, finding polling stations
cVIGIL App	Voters **report Model Code of Conduct violations** in minutes — **flying squads** navigate to the spot via auto-location for prompt action
Sugam	Web-based **vehicle management** — vehicles requisitioned from other departments for election work
ETPBS	**Service voters** receive & cast postal ballots **electronically** from anywhere outside their constituency

- **IEVP (International Election Visitors' Programme)** — ECI's flagship international cooperation programme; ECI has signed **MoUs with 28 Election Management Bodies** + 3 international organisations: **IFES, International IDEA, and the United Nations**. ⭐ IMPORTANT
- **National Voters' Day (25 January)** pledge — vote **fearlessly, without being influenced by religion, race, caste, community, language or any inducement**.

7 Political Parties

- Voters learn about candidates, policies, vision & positions on issues **primarily through political parties**; parties set the election agenda (manifestos, rallies, debates via media).
- **Functions of political parties:** organise public opinion; campaign on specific issues; **offer voters meaningful choices**; enable informed decisions; provide **governance, accountability, representation, and public engagement** — essential to a democratic system, working at the grassroots. 📌 EXAM POINT
- India has a **multi-party system** — many parties exist & compete; reflects diversity of languages, cultures, religions, regions.

7.1 Defection & the Anti-Defection Law 🔥 MUST REMEMBER

- **Defection** = abandoning or switching from the party under whose banner a candidate was elected — joining another party or acting independently of the party's decisions (e.g., voting in the legislature). Seen as **political opportunism** (or as upholding conscience/responding to public expectations).

- **Anti-Defection Law:** passed in **1985** through the **52nd Constitutional Amendment Act** — purpose: prevent defection, provide **stability to the elected government**. 📌 EXAM POINT
- If a member of Parliament or a State Assembly **voluntarily gives up party membership or votes against the party's instructions (whip)** → can be **disqualified from the House**; the **Speaker or Chairman of the House** decides such cases.

> 💡 **HINGLISH ME SAMJHO — Defection ("Aaya Ram Gaya Ram")**
> Candidate party X ki ticket se jeeta, phir chupke se party Y mein chala gaya — yeh **defection** hai (jaise "Aaya Ram, Gaya Ram"). Isse governments gir jaati thi, isliye **1985 mein 52nd Amendment** laaya gaya: agar member apni party chhoda ya **whip** (party ka voting order) ke against vote kiya → usko House se **disqualify** kar sakte hain. Speaker/Chairman faisla karta hai. Goal = stability.

7.2 Recognition criteria — National vs State party 📌 EXAM POINT

National Party (any ONE condition)	State Party (any ONE condition)
① **6% of valid votes** in **4 or more states** in a General Election (Lok Sabha or Vidhan Sabha) **+ wins 4 Lok Sabha seats**	① **6% of valid votes** in a General Election to the state's **Legislative Assembly + 2 seats** in that Assembly
② Wins **2% of Lok Sabha seats**, with candidates elected from **at least 3 states**	② **6% of valid votes** in a General Election to the **Lok Sabha from the state + 1 Lok Sabha seat**
③ Recognised as a **State Party in at least 4 states**	③ **3% of seats** in the state Legislative Assembly (or at least **3 seats**, whichever is more)
—	④ **1 Lok Sabha seat for every 25 seats** (or fraction) allotted to the state
	⑤ **8% of valid votes** polled in the state (Lok Sabha or Assembly election)

- **RUPP (Registered Unrecognised Political Parties):** parties that have not secured enough vote percentage in Legislative Assembly or General Elections, OR have **never contested since registration**.

7.3 Coalitions — the alliance era ⭐ IMPORTANT

- **1967:** end of the single-party-dominated era; **era of alliances began**.
- **1977:** parties formed an alliance as the **Janata Party** (backdrop: the National Emergency) — formed the **first coalition government at the national level** — the "Janata Government". 📌 EXAM POINT
- Since the late 1990s: **NDA** (National Democratic Alliance, led by BJP) & **UPA** (United Progressive Alliance, led by INC — dissolved 2023, reconstituted as the **Indian National Developmental Inclusive Alliance**) — the major political alliances.

8 Challenges to Free & Fair Elections

- Scale of the challenge: **96.8 crore voters (2024)**, thousands of polling stations, hundreds of parties, diverse regions & socio-economic realities.
- Key challenges: **misinformation, fake news, intimidation** (+ money power, per the chapter's discussion).
- **ECI's remedies: RPA 1950 & 1951**, the **Model Code of Conduct (MCC)**, **VVPAT** (Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail), voters' awareness campaigns & other measures.
  📌 EXAM POINT
- With **constant vigilance + active citizen participation**, elections become more representative and democracy more robust.

> 💡 **HINGLISH ME SAMJHO — Fake news ka kya karna hai?**
> WhatsApp pe "aaj hi forward karo warna vote cancel ho jayega" — sab **fake news**! Misinformation public opinion ko manipulate karti hai, intimidation se log dar kar vote nahi karte. ECI ka jawab: MCC (campaign rules), **VVPAT** (vote verify karne ki receipt — EVM galat to nahi?), awareness campaigns. Aur tumhara jawab: **verify karo, aankh band karke forward mat karo!**

9 Case Study — Ishani's First Vote 📌 EXAM POINT (source-based Q)

Ishani goes to vote (state assembly elections)

Story	Ishani (just turned **18**) registered online via the **ECI's online portal**; day before the election — wall writings & campaign posters everywhere; next morning she goes with her mother & **disabled elder brother**; polling station guarded by police; **wheelchair available**, volunteers guide them; only **3 officials performing all duties**; she forgot her Voter ID & Aadhaar — **but was still allowed to vote**; after voting she **saw her VVPAT slip**; her **89-year-old grandmother cast her vote from home**; wondered how **police personnel on duty** vote
Takeaways	① ECI initiatives: online registration, wheelchair access, volunteers, voting from home (85+ & PwDs) ② Other valid documents can replace Voter ID ③ VVPAT lets voters verify their vote ④ **Service voters** (police/army on duty) use postal ballots — **ETPBS**
MCC violations	Wall writings, posters & pamphlets pasted/distributed **near election day** violate the Model Code of Conduct

- Elections in India are also called a **"festival of democracy" — no voter is to be left behind**: even a single voter in a remote area gets a polling station.
- Debate topic: **"One Nation, One Election"** — can it improve the efficiency of the electoral process? (advantages vs limitations discussion)

10 🔥 MUST REMEMBER — Top Exam Facts

🔥 If you remember nothing else, remember these:

- Elections = **soul of democracy**: accountability, representation, legitimacy, equality; the vote = principal means of exercising this right.
- **Direct elections:** Lok Sabha, Vidhan Sabha, local bodies (every 5 years). **Indirect:** President, Vice President, Rajya Sabha.
- **FPTP → Lok Sabha & Vidhan Sabha; PR (STV) → Rajya Sabha, President, VP, Vidhan Parishad.** FPTP: most votes wins even <50% (Haritbhumi: A with 40% forms govt); PR: seats ∝ votes (Swarnalok: 40% → 40/100).
- STV: quota = valid votes ÷ seats; lowest candidate eliminated → votes **transferred** to 2nd preference; repeat till enough elected.
- **6 bicameral states:** Andhra Pradesh, Bihar, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Telangana, UP.
- **RPA 1950** = seats, delimitation, electoral rolls, 18+ voting right; **RPA 1951** = nomination, campaigns, voting, disputes, corrupt practices.
- Delimitation: **Article 82**; 4 commissions — **1952, 1963, 1973, 2002**.
- **ECI: 25 January 1950** (→ National Voters' Day); **Articles 324–329**; "superintendence, direction & control"; CEO at state level.
- ECI functions: electoral rolls (+SIR), schedule (weather, agriculture, exams, festivals), party registration & symbols (quasi-judicial), free & fair elections.
- **Anti-Defection Law: 1985, 52nd Constitutional Amendment** — leaving party or defying whip → disqualification; Speaker/Chairman decides.
- Coalitions: 1967 alliances begin; **1977 Janata Party = first national coalition**; NDA (BJP) & UPA (INC; reconstituted 2023 as INDIA alliance).
- Challenges: misinformation, fake news, intimidation → ECI's remedies: RPA, **MCC, VVPAT**, awareness campaigns.

11 ⚡ Last 5-Minute Revision

⚡ Read this 5 minutes before the exam

🗓️ DATES & NUMBERS

- 25 January 1950 — ECI established → National Voters' Day
- RPA 1950 & RPA 1951; Presidential & VP Act 1952
- Delimitation Commissions: 1952, 1963, 1973, 2002
- 1985 — Anti-Defection Law (52nd Amendment)
- 1967 alliance era; 1977 Janata Party coalition
- Elections every 5 years; voting age 18+
- Voting from home: 85+ & PwDs (40% benchmark), 2024 first nationwide

⚖️ KEY DIFFERENCES

- Direct (LS, VS, local) vs Indirect (President, VP, RS)
- FPTP (most votes, can be <50%) vs Majority (>50% or 2 rounds) vs PR (seats ∝ votes)
- National party vs State party (recognition criteria)
- Recognised parties vs RUPP
- RPA 1950 (rolls) vs RPA 1951 (conduct + disputes)

🧠 ECI IN ONE BREATH

- Autonomous, permanent, constitutional; Articles 324–329
- Superintendence, direction & control of ALL elections
- Rolls (SIR) + schedule + party registration/symbols + fairness
- Quasi-judicial in party/symbol disputes

📱 APPS (NAME → WORK)

- Suvidha — candidates' permissions & nominations
- Voter Helpline — registration, verification
- ENCORE — forms, dashboards, e-rolls
- Saksham — PwD services; cVIGIL — MCC violations (flying squads)
- Sugam — vehicles; ETPBS — service voters
- IEVP: MoUs with 28 EMBs + IFES, IDEA, UN

⚡ RAPID-FIRE FACTS

- Psephology = scientific study of elections (psēphos = pebble)
- Quota = total valid votes ÷ seats to be filled
- Vidhan Parishad: MLAs + local bodies + graduates & teachers elect; Governor nominates some
- Corrupt practices: bribery, communal appeals, govt-personnel help
- Defection = leaving the party whose ticket you won on
- First national coalition: Janata govt (1977, post-Emergency)
- No voter left behind — stations even for a single voter

12 🧠 Memory Tricks & Mnemonics

🧠 **Bicameral 6 states — "ABKMTU: Aaj Bharat Ki Maha-Teleangana-UP":** **A**ndhra, **B**ihar, **K**arnataka, **M**aharashtra, **T**elangana, **U**ttar Pradesh

🧠 **Delimitation years — "52-63-73-2002 (gap saal badhao: +11, +10, phir 29 saal jump)":** 1952, 1963, 1973, 2002

🧠 **RPA acts — "50 = Foundation (rolls), 51 = Fight (conduct & disputes)":** 1950 builds the list, 1951 polices the battle

🧠 **ECI apps — "SEVS SCE: Suvidha-Encore-Voterhelpline-Saksham-cVIGIL-Sugam-ETPBS":** remember "SEVS SCE" (Sewa-SC!) — ECI ki seva, sab apps!

🧠 **FPTP vs PR — "Race vs Pie":** FPTP = race (sabse aage = winner, chahe 30% hi ho); PR = pie (jitna vote, utna hissa — seats proportional)

🧠 **National party criteria — "6-4-4 / 2-3 / 4-states":** 6% votes in 4 states + 4 LS seats; OR 2% LS seats from 3 states; OR state party in 4 states

🧠 **Corrupt practices — "BCG (Brasht-Corrupt-Ghotala):B**ribery, **C**ommunal appeal, **G**overnment personnel misuse

🧠 **Elections importance — "ARLE (Aa Rahe hai Elections!):A**ccountability, **R**epresentation, **L**egitimacy, **E**quality

13 📝 How to Use These Points in an Answer

Q. "Explain the First-Past-The-Post system with an example." (3–5 marks)

INTRODUCTION	The FPTP (plurality) system is the electoral system used for India's Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha elections, chosen by the framers of the Constitution.
BODY (3–5 points)	① Each voter votes for one candidate in their constituency ② The candidate with the MOST votes wins — even if the votes are less than 50% of total votes polled ③ Example (from the textbook): in Haritbhumi, Party A (40%), B (35%), C (25%) — Party A wins and forms the government ④ Contrast with the majority system (needs >50%, two rounds) and PR (seats proportional to votes)
CONCLUSION	FPTP is simple and produces clear winners, though a winner may not have majority support — which is why other systems exist.

Q. "Describe the functions of the Election Commission of India." (5 marks)

INTRODUCTION	The ECI (established 25 January 1950; Articles 324–329) is an autonomous, permanent constitutional body with superintendence, direction & control of elections.
BODY (3–5 points)	① Prepares & revises electoral rolls (enumerators, SIR, claims & objections) ② Decides election schedule & dates (weather, agricultural cycle, exams, festivals) ③ Registers political parties, classifies national/state/RUPP, allots symbols; quasi-judicial role in disputes; insists on inner-party democracy ④ Ensures free, fair & inclusive elections — MCC, VVPAT, inclusion of PwDs/senior citizens/transgender persons/PVTGs, digital apps (cVIGIL, ETPBS...) ⑤ State machinery: CEO → DEOs, ROs, EROs
CONCLUSION	Through these functions, the ECI upholds the world's largest democratic exercise — free, fair and inclusive elections.

Q. (Case-study based) "Based on Ishani's first voting experience — (a) What initiatives did the ECI take? (b) Which other document might she have carried? (c) Cite MCC violations." (5 marks)

INTRODUCTION	The case shows ECI's inclusive, citizen-friendly electoral practices in action.
BODY (3–5 points)	① Online voter registration through the ECI portal ② Wheelchair + volunteer assistance for her disabled brother (PwD inclusion — Saksham) ③ Voting from home for the 89-year-old grandmother (85+ & PwDs with 40% benchmark disability) ④ She could vote without Voter ID/Aadhaar — other officially valid documents (e.g. passport, driving licence) are accepted ⑤ VVPAT slip let her verify her vote; MCC violations — wall writings, posters & pamphlets near polling day; police on duty vote as service voters via ETPBS
CONCLUSION	Such measures show "no voter is left behind" and keep elections free, fair & inclusive.